Old Sturgeon

Issue No. 4 August 2026

Grand and In-Demand

A 40-Minute Expedition



You'll need: 1. A phone, 2. Chin up, 3. Self-assurance

Start at the north-east corner of Lexington and 17th. Search for a catio in a basement window. Cat or no cat, enjoy the Sunflowers. Flip the page to 2. (Blue Heron).

2. Blue Heron

Walk downhill on Lexington. Turn your gaze from side to side, so people know you're inspecting the scene.
At 19th, search for a pink jellyfish. Stand one foot away from the jellyfish and face it. Look to the right and a little to the back. What do you see?
A basketball hoop? Proceed to page 4 (Duck).
A soccer goal? Turn to page 7 (Maple).

2. Crow

Turn left and start walking faster. Do not run. GIDs keep their cool.
At Lambert, cross the street. Stop.

If Lambert from where you are to 17th is downhill, proceed to page 5 (Nutria).
Otherwise, turn to page 6 (Squirrel).



3. Fly

GIDs collect evidence for later investigation. Cross Nehalem and turn left. Find the stained -glass door little library in front of 1816 Nehalem, reach inside, pick up a random book, and turn to page 25. Take a picture, close the volume and place it back in the library. Walk away nodding your head in contemplation.

If you are not alone, say, "I wonder what the supercomputer will have to say when we get back home," and the other person answers "I have a feeling that the Orient Express case is almost solved."

If you're alone, take your phone out and pretend you are leaving a voice message with similar content. Move to page 7 (Maple).



4. Duck

Grand and In-Demand people (GIDs) get emergency calls, and respond with coolness and dignity.
Take your phone out, as if it just vibrated. Announce, "<your last name, e.g. Marlowe>." Pause. Respond, "Aha...I understand," like the caller describes a crisis. Pretend to listen — no, believe you're listening.
State calmly, "I am on my way... Hang in there." Don't just imagine these things, say them loudly as you walk down Lexington St.

When you get to 21st, stop, finish the phone call by saying, "I'll be there in 90 seconds," and flip to page 2 (Crow).



5. Nutria

GIDs have epiphanies.
Continue toward Milwaukie Ave. Beyond the fence on your left, an old steeple. When you see it say, "A steeple, of course!" turn around and rush back toward 17th.
Don't be shy. Say it. If you're a group, the other(s) can say, "How'd we miss that? A steeple!"

Cross 17th, and turn right. Walk to Nehalem. Pump your fists from time to time.
Shout "Eureka!"
At Nehalem, open page 3 (Fly).



6. Squirrel

Walk on Lambert toward 20th. Cross 20th. Halt.
Aim your eyes West-North-West.
See a house with two trees at the entrance?
If they are oak, go to page 6 (Cat).
If Washingtonia palms, jump to
7 (Washingtonia).



6. Cat

GIDs are humble. Get a call announcing you've received a combined Nobel Prize, Oscar, and Medal of Freedom—merged specially for your incredible achievement.
Keep your equanimity. Say something like, "I am just happy I could help," or "There are so many people that made it possible," or "I am but a dwarf standing on the shoulders of giants," or anything else that reflects your sincere humility.
Your modesty gives you the last seal of perfection.



7. Maple
Congratulations, you have transformed into a GID! Remember to practice your favorite technique from the expidition: epiphanies, collecting evidence, being broadcast, or receiving a call for rescue.
Turn to page 8.

7. Washingtonia
GIDs know their lives are always broadcast. As you walk uphill to Lambert and 17th, imagine a TV show in your head.
Host: "Marlowe is doing a fantastic time on the Great Lambert Pass, one of the toughest runs of the Tour De Sellwood."
Expert: "That's true, Host, and it's not only technique! You can almost smell how much heart Marlowe is putting into this — I believe we're going to witness a world record today."

When you arrive at 17th, hear Host saying, "You were right, Expert! Marlowe breaks a record that stood for over twenty years, what a day!" Stop, cross both Lambert and 17th to end up on the southwest corner, and flip to page 5 (Nutria).



Scan the QR code and send us an email with the picture of page 25 in whatever book you picked up. Make an observation about why that finding is so important, (something like, "Notice the first lower case 't' on the fifth line. Do you see what I'm seeing? I think we're onto something.") We'll respond, mysteriously, to every email.



Bonus Challenge: If you still have an air of importance in you, jump to page 6 (Cat).



Old Sturgeon zine created by
Tilly & Knimonares
All issues linked in our bio @oldsturgeonpdx

Etsy shop: OldSturgeonPDX.Etsy.com

© 2026 OldSturgeonPDX